

MARKET PULSE · MID-WEEK TRADING REPORT

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Wednesday 26 August 2026

OUTLOOK · NEUTRAL-BULLISH

MACRO THEME

Gold extends to fresh multi-month highs (\$4,731) as Treasury bond-market angst overshadows equity resilience. Treasury buyback expansion (\$2B to \$4B) failed to calm the long end; Bessent jawboning reversed both days. Iran sanctions escalated to 'economic warfare' phase. US30 resilient, NAS100 bleeding under 10Y at 4.696%. NVDA earnings and Core PCE converge today for maximum event risk. Jackson Hole begins Thursday with Warsh speech Saturday paramount.

OVERVIEW

Rising long-dated Treasury yields (10Y at 4.696%, 30Y near 2007 highs) triggered a tech sell-off while fiscal sustainability angst drove gold to multi-month highs. US30 outperformed (+0.26% Mon) as value/industrial composition insulated it from duration headwinds. NAS100 continued to struggle below broken 30,000 support. Treasury buyback expansion failed; rumours of further TGA-funded purchases circulate. Iran 'economic warfare' sanctions escalated but oil fell (Brent -2.5% to \$92) as traders focused on supply realities. Merck/Moderna cancer vaccine breakthrough lifted health care. Core PCE (Wed), NVDA earnings (Wed after close), and Jackson Hole with Fed Chair Warsh (Sat) form an extraordinary 72-hour event-risk cluster.

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LIVE MARKET DATA

INSTRUMENT	PRICE	DAY CHG %	DAY RANGE	52W RANGE	SIGNAL
US30	53,577	+0.30%	53,386 – 53,675	44,948 – 54,744	NEU-BULL
NAS100	29,209	+0.64%	29,078 – 29,339	22,841 – 30,762	NEU-BEAR
GER40	26,266	+0.61%	26,164 – 26,342	21,864 – 26,574	NEUTRAL
AUDUSD	0.7185	+0.25%	0.7163 – 0.7189	0.6422 – 0.7277	NEU-BULL
GBPCAD	1.8898	+0.08%	1.8864 – 1.8904	1.8018 – 1.9041	NEU-BULL
XAGUSD	69.32	-0.19%	68.19 – 69.75	38.68 – 121.30	BULLISH
XAUUSD	4,703	-0.05%	4,686 – 4,731	3,382 – 5,586	BULLISH

SCORECARD VS PREVIOUS REPORT

INSTRUMENT	PREVIOUS BIAS	RESULT	VERDICT
US30	NEUTRAL-BULLISH	+0.56%, outperformed tech, held above prior-week close both sessions	CORRECT
NAS100	NEUTRAL-BEARISH	-0.34%, yield pressure continued, 30,000 broken support confirmed	CORRECT
GER40	NEUTRAL	+0.50%, range trade intact 25,983-26,441	CORRECT
AUDUSD	NEUTRAL-BULLISH	+0.24%, commodity tailwinds supported, grinding toward 0.7200	CORRECT
GBPCAD	NEUTRAL	+0.35%, mild upside drift, 1.89 breached	CORRECT
XAGUSD	BULLISH	-0.31%, failed to track gold higher, gold/silver ratio widened	PARTIALLY
XAUUSD	BULLISH	+0.47%, surged to 4,731 intraday, multi-month high, trend intact	CORRECT

TOP CONVICTION TRADES

#1 XAUUSD LONG

ENTRY	TARGET	STOP
4,680-4,700	4,741 (initial), 4,800 (extended)	4,630

Strongest signal (75) in the 7-instrument basket with multiple converging tailwinds: fiscal sustainability angst (Treasury buyback failure), geopolitical premium (Iran economic warfare sanctions), central bank buying, and softening real yields. Prior conviction trade target at 4,700 hit. 4,741 confirmation trigger is the key level — close above opens 4,800. Risk: hot PCE today or hawkish Warsh Saturday. Risk-reward 1:1.5 to 4,741; runner to 4,800.

#2 NAS100 SHORT

ENTRY	TARGET	STOP
29,400-29,500	28,500	29,850

Rising long-dated Treasury yields (10Y 4.696%, 30Y near 2007 highs) are a structural headwind for long-duration growth/tech. 30,000 is broken support confirmed as resistance. NVDA earnings tonight are binary — wait for post-NVDA gap to settle before entering. Yield headwind persists regardless of NVDA outcome. Jackson Hole adds risk-off potential. Risk-reward 1:1.8.

#3 XAGUSD LONG

ENTRY	TARGET	STOP
68.50-69.00	72.00	67.40

Beta play on gold rally. Silver underperformed this week (-0.22% vs gold +1.70%) but the divergence should close. Gold/silver ratio at 67.8x is historically elevated — ratio mean-reversion provides tailwind. Sunday conviction trade triggered (Tue low 68.12) and currently +0.3-0.9% in profit. Industrial demand provides structural floor. Risk-reward 1:2.3. Manage existing position; add on dips.

INSTRUMENT ANALYSIS · 1 OF 7

US30

Dow Jones Industrial Average

53,577

+160 · +0.30%

NEU·BULL · +35

14-DAY PRICE ACTION



DAY RANGE	52-WEEK RANGE	PREVIOUS CLOSE	EVENT IMPACT
53,386 – 53,675	44,948 – 54,744	53,417	75%

SUPPORTS		RESISTANCES			
S1	Prior Friday close — first defensive floor	53,277	R1	Aug 13 high cluster — first ceiling	53,840
S2	Aug 20 sell-off low — must hold	52,759	R2	Aug 6 high / pre-yield-spike level	54,503
S3	Round number / deeper structural support	52,000	R3	All-time high	54,744

ANALYSIS

US30 is the best house in a rough neighbourhood. Recovered ~80% of the Aug 20 bond-yield rout (52,759 low to 53,577). Value/industrial composition insulates it from duration sell-off hitting NAS100. Health care sector boosted by Merck/Moderna cancer vaccine breakthrough. Consumer resilience supports the floor. Key risk: PCE today and Jackson Hole Saturday. 3-day bias: NEUTRAL-BULLISH. Buy dips toward 53,300-53,400 stop 52,700 target 54,200.

NAS100

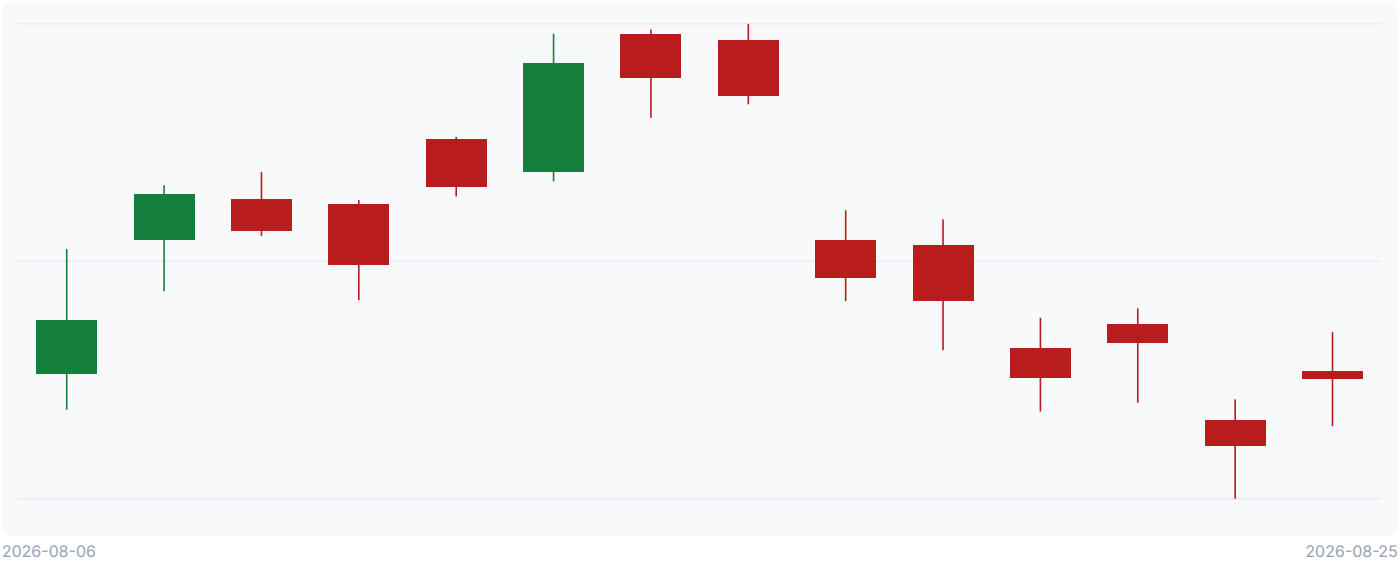
Nasdaq 100

29,209

+186 · +0.64%

NEU-BEAR · -55

14-DAY PRICE ACTION



DAY RANGE	52-WEEK RANGE	PREVIOUS CLOSE	EVENT IMPACT
29,078 – 29,339	22,841 – 30,762	29,023	90%

SUPPORTS		RESISTANCES	
S1	Monday low — near-term floor	R1	Prior breakdown zone — first ceiling
S2	Aug 24 intraday low	R2	Broken support, now firmly resistance
S3	Measured-move target / structural support	R3	Aug 13 high / pre-yield-spike high
	29,023		29,500
	28,876		30,000
	28,500		30,168

ANALYSIS

NAS100 is the clear underperformer. Broken 30,000 support confirmed as resistance — price has not tested it from below. Rising real yields (10Y at 4.696%, 30Y near 2007 highs) are a structural headwind for long-duration growth. NVDA earnings tonight create binary 5%+ gap risk. 3-day bias: NEUTRAL-BEARISH. Sell rallies toward 29,400-29,500 stop 29,850 target 28,500. Do not hold through NVDA without explicit gap risk sizing.

GER40

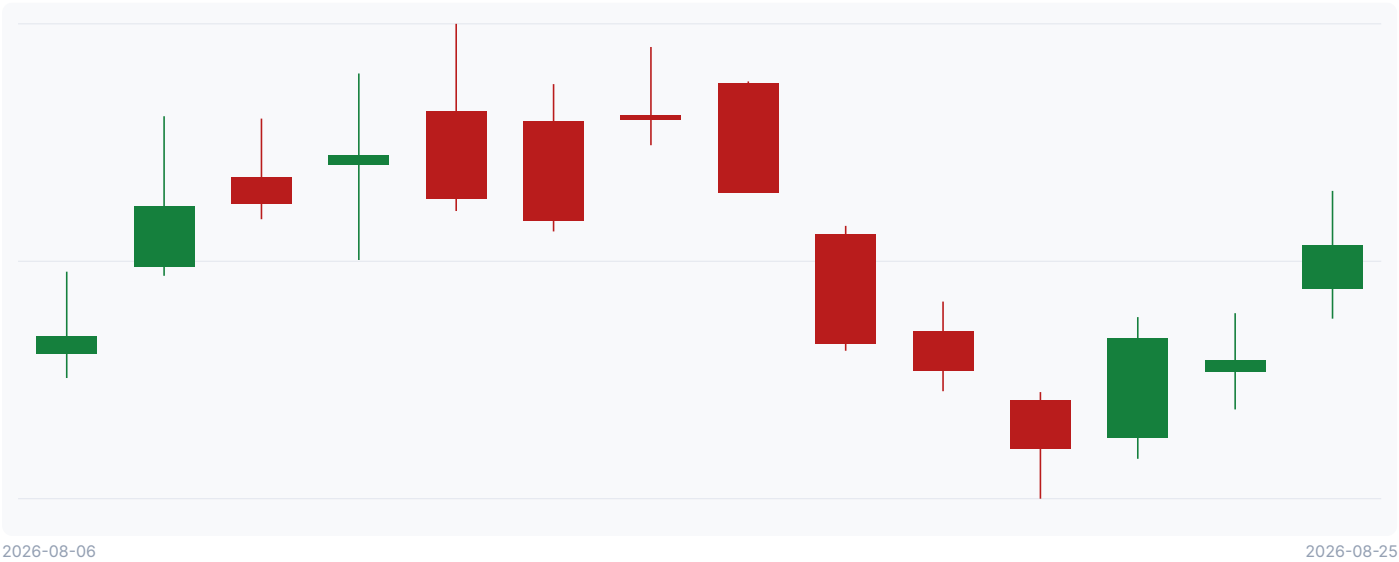
DAX Performance Index

26,266

+160 • +0.61%

NEUTRAL • +10

14-DAY PRICE ACTION



DAY RANGE

26,164 – 26,342

52-WEEK RANGE

21,864 – 26,574

PREVIOUS CLOSE

26,107

EVENT IMPACT

60%

SUPPORTS

- S1** Aug 20 low — near-term floor **25,983**
- S2** Aug 20 intraday low — August range bottom **25,914**
- S3** Deeper structural support **25,700**

RESISTANCES

- R1** Aug 14 high / range ceiling **26,441**
- R2** Year high — price discovery above **26,573**
- R3** Measured-move projection **26,800**

ANALYSIS

GER40 is range-bound between 25,914 and 26,573. Outperformed US tech last week (-0.77% vs NAS100 -2.05%). Less rate-sensitive composition (industrials, autos, pharma) provides relative insulation. Brent falling 2.5% to \$92 eases input costs for German manufacturers. German IFO today expected 87.3 — near-term catalyst. 3-day bias: NEUTRAL. Range trade 25,980-26,440. Buy near 26,020 stop 25,880 target 26,400. Break above 26,573 flips to BULLISH; break below 25,914 flips to BEARISH.

AUDUSD

Australian Dollar vs US Dollar

0.7185

+0.0018 • +0.25%

NEU·BULL • +45

14-DAY PRICE ACTION



DAY RANGE

0.7163 – 0.7189

52-WEEK RANGE

0.6422 – 0.7277

PREVIOUS CLOSE

0.7167

EVENT IMPACT

80%

SUPPORTS

- S1** Tuesday close — first pullback level **0.7155**
- S2** Prior resistance-turned-support zone **0.7120**
- S3** Aug 17 breakout level **0.7082**

RESISTANCES

- R1** Today's high — immediate ceiling **0.7189**
- R2** Psychological round number **0.7200**
- R3** Year high **0.7277**

ANALYSIS

AUDUSD surged +2.2% from Aug 7 low of 0.7033 to 0.7186. Commodity tailwinds (gold, iron ore, energy) provide structural support. RBA/Fed rate differential (4.35% vs 3.50-3.75%) is AUD-positive. Jackson Hole Warsh speech Saturday is the key risk — hawkish = USD strength, AUDUSD pressure. Prior conviction trade (entry 0.7150-0.7160) remains open. 3-day bias: NEUTRAL-BULLISH. Buy dips 0.7150-0.7160 stop 0.7115 target 0.7220.

GBPCAD

British Pound vs Canadian Dollar

1.8898

+0.0016 • +0.08%

NEU•BULL • +35

14-DAY PRICE ACTION



DAY RANGE	52-WEEK RANGE	PREVIOUS CLOSE	EVENT IMPACT
1.8864 – 1.8904	1.8018 – 1.9041	1.8883	55%

SUPPORTS		RESISTANCES			
S1	Today's low — immediate floor	1.8864	R1	Tuesday high — range ceiling being tested	1.8911
S2	Psychological round number / pivot	1.8800	R2	Prior resistance cluster	1.8950
S3	Aug 21 low — range floor	1.8741	R3	Year high	1.9041

ANALYSIS

GBPCAD grinding higher on GBP resilience and CAD weakness (oil falling 2.5% to \$92 Brent). Range ceiling at 1.8911 tested Tuesday and held. Bullish break above opens 1.8950-1.9000. BoE hawkish hold at 3.75% supports GBP. 3-day bias: NEUTRAL-BULLISH. Buy pullback to 1.8860-1.8870 stop 1.8790 target 1.8950. Rejection at 1.8911 keeps range trade intact.

XAGUSD

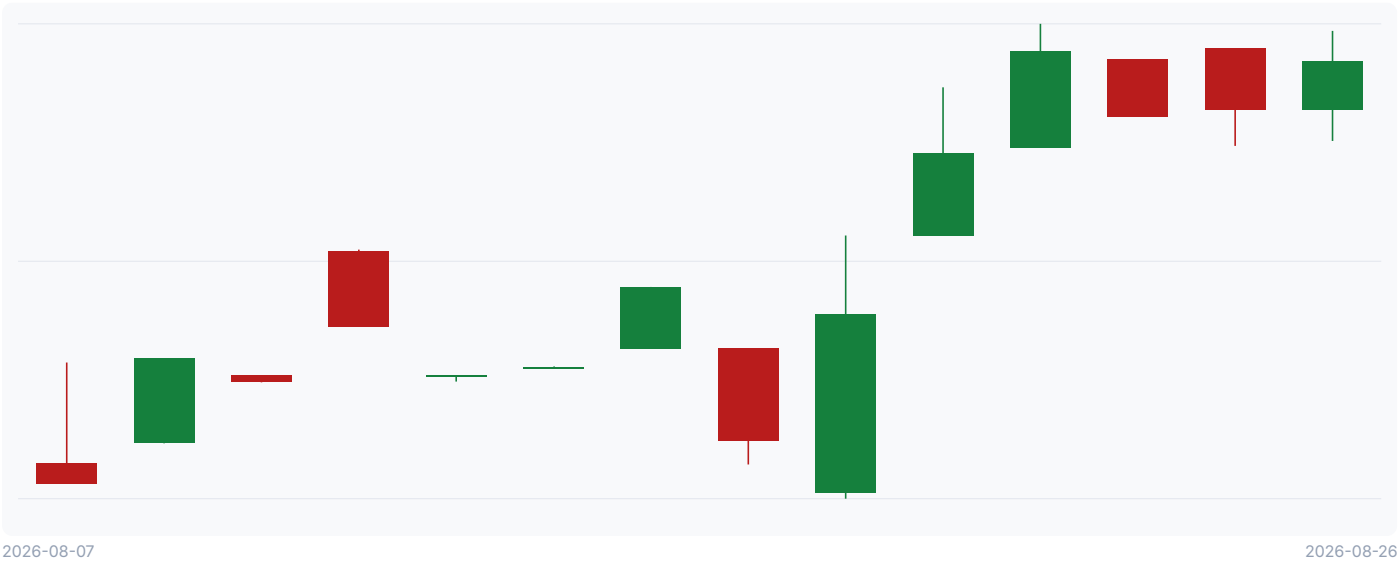
Silver Spot

69.32

-0.13 · -0.19%

BULLISH · +55

14-DAY PRICE ACTION



DAY RANGE	52-WEEK RANGE	PREVIOUS CLOSE	EVENT IMPACT
68.19 – 69.75	38.68 – 121.30	69.45	80%

SUPPORTS			RESISTANCES		
S1	Today's low — conviction trade entry floor	68.19	R1	Today's high — immediate ceiling	69.75
S2	Conviction trade stop level	67.40	R2	Aug 21 high / multi-week high	69.85
S3	Deeper structural support / Aug 17 low	66.00	R3	Conviction trade target / next resistance	72.00

ANALYSIS

Silver underperformed gold this week (-0.22% vs +1.70%) as the gold rally is driven by fiscal/safe-haven demand, not industrial. Gold/silver ratio widened to 67.8x. Conviction trade from Sunday triggered (Tue low 68.12, Wed low 68.19), currently +0.3-0.9% in profit. Gold rally intact so silver beta should eventually catch up. 3-day bias: BULLISH. Hold existing long, buy dips 68.50-69.00 stop 67.40 target 72.00. Below 67.40 invalidates.

XAUUSD

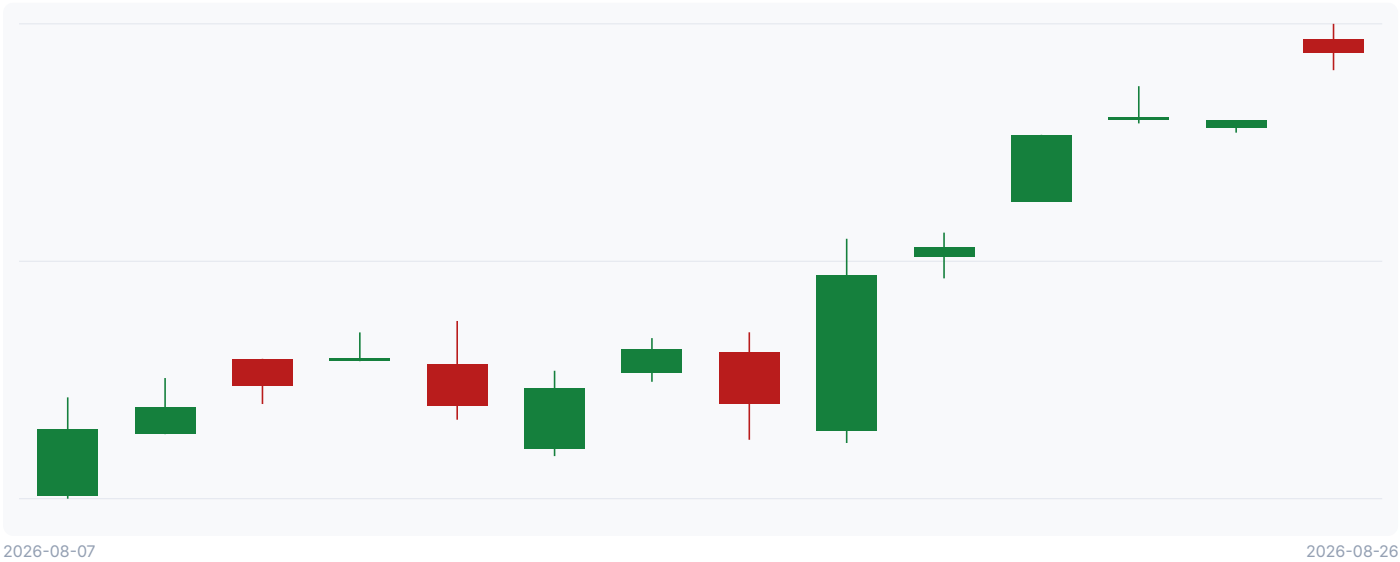
Gold Spot

4,703

-2 • -0.05%

BULLISH • +75

14-DAY PRICE ACTION



DAY RANGE

4,686 – 4,731

52-WEEK RANGE

3,382 – 5,586

PREVIOUS CLOSE

4,705

EVENT IMPACT

85%

SUPPORTS

- S1** Today's low — near-term floor 4,686
- S2** Prior resistance area — now support 4,630
- S3** Conviction trade stop zone / trend support 4,540

RESISTANCES

- R1** Today's high — immediate ceiling 4,731
- Confirmation trigger from prior reports —
- R2** major level 4,741
- R3** Next psychological target 4,800
- R4** Iran-war all-time high 5,602

ANALYSIS

Gold surged +10.0% from Aug 4 low of 4,274 to today's 4,731 high. Multiple converging tailwinds: fiscal sustainability angst (Treasury buyback failed to calm bonds), geopolitical premium (Iran 'economic warfare' sanctions), central bank buying (PBoC, RBI), softer real yields (10Y -3.8bp Mon). Prior conviction trade target at 4,700 HIT. 4,741 confirmation trigger within reach. 3-day bias: BULLISH. Buy dips 4,680-4,700 stop 4,630 target 4,741 initial / 4,800 extended. Do not chase above 4,730. Jackson Hole Warsh Saturday is paramount risk.

UPCOMING EVENTS

DATE	TIME	EVENT	IMPACT
2026-08-26	08:00 GMT	German IFO Business Climate (Aug)	Medium
2026-08-26	12:30 GMT	US Core PCE Price Index (Jul) m/m	Very High
2026-08-26	12:30 GMT	US Durable Goods Orders (Jul prelim)	High
2026-08-26	12:30 GMT	US GDP Q2 Second Reading	High
2026-08-26	20:20 GMT	NVDA Q2 FY2027 Earnings (after close)	Very High
2026-08-27	12:30 GMT	US Weekly Jobless Claims	Medium
2026-08-27	14:00 GMT	Jackson Hole Symposium begins	Very High
2026-08-28	09:45 GMT	Chicago PMI (Aug)	Medium
2026-08-29	14:00 GMT	Jackson Hole — Fed Chair Warsh Speech	Paramount

RISK SCENARIOS

Hot Core PCE Print (>0.3% m/m) Today

20%

USD-positive, gold -1 to -3%, equities -1 to -2%. Removes any residual dovish Fed narrative and compounds yield pressure. Directly challenges XAUUSD and XAGUSD longs while benefiting NAS100 short.

NVDA Earnings Disappointment Tonight

25%

NAS100 -3 to -5% gap risk, US30 -1 to -2%. AI capex narrative partially unwinds. Validates NAS100 short. Strong beat (60% probability) could briefly flip tech sentiment but yield headwinds cap follow-through.

Hawkish Warsh at Jackson Hole Saturday

30%

USD +1 to +2%, gold -2 to -4%, equities -1 to -3%. Warsh signals higher-for-longer or hike resumption. Unwinds significant portion of gold rally. Single most important risk for precious metals complex.

Dovish/Fiscally-Concerned Warsh at Jackson Hole

25%

USD -1%, gold +2 to +3%, equities +1 to +2%. Warsh expresses fiscal trajectory concerns or tolerance for above-target inflation. Adds fuel to gold, pressures USD.

Iran Conflict Escalation Beyond Sanctions

15%

Strait of Hormuz disruption, oil +10 to +15%, gold +3 to +5%, equities -2 to -4%. 'Economic warfare' escalates to kinetic action. Tail risk but dominant geopolitical scenario. Oil's decline Monday (-2.5%) suggests markets discounting this.